Abdullah, who had been talking about independence for Kashmir, and invited him to visit Beijing.[138]

Given the sense of external and internal challenge, few Indian policymakers would have disagreed with Bowles's "two-dimensional" solution to India's defense problem vis-à-vis China: (1) an adequate military defense shield and (2) the building of [a] vigorous, dynamic society which is impervious to covert Chinese Communist infiltration."[139] There was also little argument about the *ends* that the US strategy was designed to achieve—a contained China and a strengthened India. There was, furthermore, a continued Indian desire for US military and economic support, especially when Moscow started engaging Islamabad.

Disagreements, however, emerged with the US over *ways and means*. These differences on how to meet the China threat set limits on the US-India relationship, even as that very threat kept the relationship from unraveling. Differences on three issues, in particular, had an impact: the defense–development balance, the Soviet role in India's diversification strategy, and whether or not Pakistan could be part of India's China solution.

### *Guns or Butter*

The elements of Washington's India policy were connected to each other and to other US interests. At best, American policymakers expected that a sound and well-prioritized Indian development strategy—aided by the US—would strengthen Indian democracy; at the very least, it would keep the communists in India at bay. Economic development could also mean more indigenous Indian defense capacity against China, thus reducing the burden on the US. Furthermore, a politically, militarily, and economically strengthened India would offer a less tempting target to China.

A major American emphasis was to encourage India to balance its defense and development efforts in a way that the latter did not suffer. The American desire for India to strike this balance was largely responsible for the long time it took to negotiate further military assistance to strengthen India against China. In developing a defense package, Johnson instructed US officials in December 1963 to encourage India to limit its force levels, procurement from the Soviet bloc, and diversion of foreign exchange from development to defense needs, as well as to "exercise restraint" vis-à-vis